



Caiuajara is thought to have been an herbivore—it ate only plants.

Learning to fly

The chicks developed fast and were soon able to fly. They tested out their wing muscles by taking short flights while staying close to home.

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Vulnerable chicks

The young were helpless at first and relied on their parents for food. The large group, or colony, provided safety in numbers for the fragile chicks.

Pterosaur

At the time of the dinosaurs, flying reptiles called pterosaurs dominated the skies.

Caiuajara was a pterosaur from South America who lived around 91 million years ago, during a period called the Late Cretaceous.

Living together Today's colonial birds, such as flamingos, nest and breed in large groups. The discovery of a site containing many Caiuajara fossils, including eggs, babies, and adults, suggests that they lived in a similar way.

